

Episode 5: From Prison to the Throne

Based on Qur'an, Surah Yusuf (12) : 43-57

Years later, the King of Egypt dreamed of seven fat cows being devoured by seven lean ones, and seven green ears of grain alongside withered ones (Qur'an 12:43). No one could interpret it, until the young man who had once been saved from prison finally remembered Yusuf (12:45).

Yusuf interpreted the dream with great wisdom: seven fruitful years would be followed by seven years of famine, and he proposed a prudent strategy for storing grain (12:47-49). The king wished to free him at once, but Yusuf — with remarkable integrity — first asked that the earlier false accusation against him be properly investigated, rather than simply being released without his name cleared (12:50). When the women of the city, including Al-Aziz's wife, finally admitted Yusuf's innocence and their own wrongdoing (12:51), his reputation was fully restored.

Yusuf was then appointed to high office, and he himself proposed, "Appoint me over the storehouses of the land. Indeed, I will be a knowing guardian" (12:55). Thus did Allah grant Yusuf a position of honor in the land of Egypt (12:56) — the reward for the long patience he had endured, from the well, to slavery, to false accusation, to imprisonment, and finally to a position of trust and leadership.

Reflection: Yusuf's honesty and integrity — choosing to clear

his name before rushing to freedom — model that one's honor is worth more than freedom alone.

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